



Partly sunny 80/65 • Tomorrow: A p.m. shower 85/69 C20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 22, 2025 • \$4

Officials set to tie Tylenol to autism risk

Trump administration expected to warn against use in early pregnancy

BY DAN DIAMOND AND ARIANA EUNJUNG CHA

The Trump administration is expected to unveil new efforts Monday exploring how one medication may be linked to autism and another one can treat it, according to four people with knowledge of the plans who spoke on the condition of anonymity because the announcement was not yet public.

Federal health officials are expected to raise concerns about pregnant women's use of acetaminophen, the active ingredient in Tylenol and one of the most widely used medications globally. Officials have been reviewing previous research — including an August review by Mount Sinai and Harvard researchers — that suggests a possible link between Tylenol use early on in pregnancy and an increased risk of autism in children. They plan to warn pregnant women against using Tylenol early on unless they have a fever, according to the four individuals.

In addition, officials plan to tout a lesser-known drug called leucovorin as a potential autism treatment. Leucovorin is typically prescribed to counteract some medications' side effects and to treat vitamin B9 deficiency. Early double-blind, placebo-controlled trials administering leucovorin to children with autism have shown what some scientists describe as remarkable improvements in their ability to speak and understand others. Officials at the Food and Drug Administration have recently been reviewing language that could apply to the drug.

The findings on leucovorin have sent ripples through the scientific community, sparking

SEE AUTISM ON A5

WHITE HOUSE SHUT DOWN PROBE OF BORDER CZAR

As a private citizen in 2024, Tom Homan allegedly accepted cash from undercover FBI agents. A2

"I know I speak for everyone here today when I say that none of us will ever forget Charlie Kirk, and neither now will history."

President Donald Trump



CHENEY ORR/REUTERS

Kirk hailed as GOP 'martyr'

At memorial, thousands join Trump and conservative leaders to remember the slain activist

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, YVONNE WINGETT SANCHEZ AND MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

PHOENIX — Republicans extolled conservative activist Charlie Kirk at a memorial Sunday as a religious leader of almost biblical stature who transformed the party and was critical to delivering the presidency to Donald Trump. More than a dozen of the party's most powerful leaders predicted that Kirk's slaying will galvanize their political movement for generations to come.

"He's a martyr now for American freedom," President Donald Trump said after walking onstage to a fireworks display while country singer Lee Greenwood performed "God Bless the USA." "I know I speak for everyone here today when I say that none of us will ever forget Charlie Kirk, and neither now will history."

Supporters of the 31-year-old co-founder of



ROSS D. FRANKLIN/AP

Turning Point USA packed into the Arizona Cardinals' stadium, creating an unprecedented event that combined elements of an old-fashioned tent revival with the trappings of a political rally. Posters of Kirk and his family adorned the interior. Packets of tissues had been placed on the seats, along with Turning Point placards. Thousands of people who could not fit into the venue spilled into a nearby arena. Christian worship and gospel music played as people waved "Never Surrender" signs, invoking one of Trump's campaign slogans made popular in 2024 after he survived an assassination attempt.

Vice President JD Vance, five Trump Cabinet officials, Charlie Kirk's widow, Erika Kirk, and other speakers delivered at times emotional remembrances of Kirk behind bulletproof glass, a doleful reminder of the shooting on Sept. 10 that had brought them here. Many of

SEE MEMORIAL ON A8

TOP: Mourners at a memorial service for slain conservative commentator Charlie Kirk at State Farm Stadium in Glendale, Arizona, on Sunday. ABOVE: President Donald Trump embraces Kirk's widow, Erika Kirk.

Many in U.S. feel the pinch

NEW HOMES, JOBS SEEM OUT OF REACH

Americans say they are economically stuck

BY ABHA BHATTARAI

A mix of high borrowing costs, dwindling job openings and growing economic and political uncertainty have left many U.S. households at a standstill, with many Americans saying they feel unable to buy new homes, take new jobs or move to new cities.

The Federal Reserve's interest rate cut last week — the first of the year, with the expectation that more will follow — may have boosted stock prices, but it isn't likely to make much of a difference to everyday Americans, economists say. While the economy is generally in good shape, many people feel stuck.

"Consumers have been increasingly paralyzed by economic uncertainty, tariffs, rising inflation, chances of a recession — and a quarter-point change in the Federal Funds Rate rates isn't going to solve those problems," said Jessica Riedl, senior fellow at the Manhattan Institute, a conservative think tank. "There are much larger headwinds holding back the economy that must be addressed first."

Monthly home sales have recently bottomed out, reaching lows last seen after the Great

SEE ECONOMY ON A4

U.S. allies recognize Palestine as a state

U.K., Canada, Australia break with Washington in major diplomatic shift

BY STEVE HENDRIX

LONDON — Britain, Canada and Australia formally recognized a state of Palestine on Sunday, reversing decades of unwillingness to accept Palestinians as a sovereign nation until their conflict with Israel was permanently settled and breaking sharply with the United States.

The three nations became the biggest countries to recognize a Palestinian state, acting in coordination with France, which is expected to make a similar declaration on Monday at the United Nations. Later Sunday, Portuguese Foreign Minister Paulo Rangel announced from the U.N. that his country was also formally recognizing a Palestinian state.

Their embrace of Palestinian statehood is a momentous shift in long-standing diplomatic positions and reflects the grave consternation in many capitals over Israel's war in Gaza.

Britain, Canada and France, the first members of the Group of Seven major economies to take such a step, are some of the most

SEE PALESTINE ON A14



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Commanders crush Raiders

Jaylin Lane returns a punt 90 yards for a touchdown as Washington gets back to its winning ways, 41-24. Story, C1

In Kenya, a search for U.S. champions

Recruiting of NCAA runners is changing the face of college athletics

BY KEVIN SIEFF

ELDORET, KENYA — The runners came from across Kenya, lured by the top prize in the 3,000 meters: the chance to move to the United States and compete for a leading American college. Organizers advertised the race as "The Golden Ticket."

On loudspeakers at the edge of the dirt track, announcers listed the schools that were looking for Kenyans.

"The University of Alabama, the University of Arizona, the University of New Mexico ..." echoed over jangly Kenyan pop music.

News of the time trial swept through this capital of long-distance running. Even as academic scholarships and student visas have come under attack by the Trump administration, college running was one path to the United States that had expanded.

The recruiting drive in East Af-



MALIN FEZEHA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Young athletes from Complete Sports Training Center during a morning running session in Kaptagat, Kenya, in May.

rica is changing the face of college athletics. Last season, Kenyan women took the top three places in the NCAA cross-country championships. And Texas Tech recruited 28-year-old Solomon Kipchoge, another Kenyan whose half-marathon time was faster than the American record when he enrolled as a freshman.

Now it was Dismas Kiprotich

and Kelvin Kiptoo's turn. They stretched in the grass next to the track, all sinew and muscle, neither of them over 140 pounds, waiting for their heats.

In the lead-up to the trials, Kiprotich, 24, fixated on the qualifying time — 8 minutes and 12 seconds — and how quickly he would need to run each lap. Kiptoo, 20,

SEE KENYA ON A20

IN THE NEWS

Free-speech defender First Amendment lawyer Jenin Younes made her name suing President Joe Biden over censorship. She says President Donald Trump is worse. A6

U.S. hunger report ended The Trump administration is terminating the annual reports as domestic food insecurity rises. A3

THE NATION
Instructors at the FAA's training academy say they are being pushed to the brink. A3
California will ban federal agents from using masks to hide their faces starting Jan. 1. A3

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Back in power in Afghanistan, the Taliban are quietly making diplomatic inroads. A14

THE ECONOMY
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Cybersecurity experts warn that AI technology is ushering in a golden age of hacking. A16

STYLE
A longtime mustache wearer pans the dramatic overgrowth of the facial-hair style in recent years. B1
Cardi B's "Am I the Drama?," her first album in seven years, finds her back atop the rap world, Chris Kelly writes. B1

THE REGION
Prosecutors are seeking a 30-year sentence for the Californian who plotted to kill Supreme Court Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh in 2022. C11

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